Activity 08 - Budget and Effectiveness Decision

- Course: Infographics and Data Visualization with PowerPoint (TGS-2026064178)
- Duration: 30 minutes
- Tools: Excel scorecard + PowerPoint
- Output: Formula-driven scorecard, 12-month resource recommendation and decision slide

Objective

Compare infographic-tool investment options and recommend a resource plan using effectiveness and governance criteria.

Scenario

Northstar can fund one standard workflow for 12 staff. Options include PowerPoint templates only, PowerPoint with Copilot, Gemini Notebook with PowerPoint, or a mixed AI workflow with PowerPoint as the controlled final-production layer. Use the supplied budget workbook and effectiveness evidence to recommend a 12-month tool, training and governance plan aligned with business outcomes.

Detailed instructions

1. Open the options workbook. Open A08-Budget-and-Effectiveness-Decision-Data.xlsx and review Assumptions, Options, Scorecard and Recommendation.

2. Confirm the business need. Record the number of users, infographic volume, required channels, approved data classification and business outcome.

3. Review total resource cost. Check licence, training, production, review, governance, maintenance and estimated rework costs. Do not compare licence fees alone.

4. Set decision weights. Use the supplied weights or adjust them with a written rationale. Keep effectiveness and hard governance gates visible.

5. Score each workflow. Score PowerPoint templates, PowerPoint + Copilot, Gemini Notebook + PowerPoint and Mixed AI tools + PowerPoint using the same scale and evidence.

6. Test hard gates. Mark any option that fails data handling, rights, editability, accessibility or continuity as Not eligible regardless of weighted score.

7. Review formulas. Confirm weighted totals and 12-month costs recalculate. Resolve any #REF!, #DIV/0!, #VALUE!, #N/A or #NAME? error before proceeding.

8. Write the recommendation. In the Recommendation sheet name the preferred workflow, 12-month budget, training plan, governance controls, owner, success metrics and review date.

9. Create the decision slide. Open A08-Budget-and-Effectiveness-Decision-Start.pptx and add a native comparison chart, key trade-offs and one explicit recommendation.

10. Challenge the decision. Ask which evidence could reverse the choice. Record the trigger and the date for the formal review.

Suggested timing

- 5 minutes - Confirm need and assumptions
- 10 minutes - Review cost and score options
- 7 minutes - Apply hard gates and validate formulas

- 6 minutes - Write recommendation and decision slide
- 2 minutes - Challenge and submit

Included inputs and assets

- Synthetic CSV and formula-enabled XLSX mock data
- Editable PowerPoint start and worked-example files
- PROMPTS.md with copy-ready data-analysis, infographic, Gemini Notebook and text-to-image prompts
- AI Prompt Lab worksheet for provenance and human-change records

Submission

Submit the editable PPTX, completed XLSX, source CSV, prompt/source log, used assets and checklist. Record every AI tool, prompt, source, rejected claim and material human change.

Debrief

The recommendation names the preferred workflow, budget, ownership, governance controls, success metrics and review date.